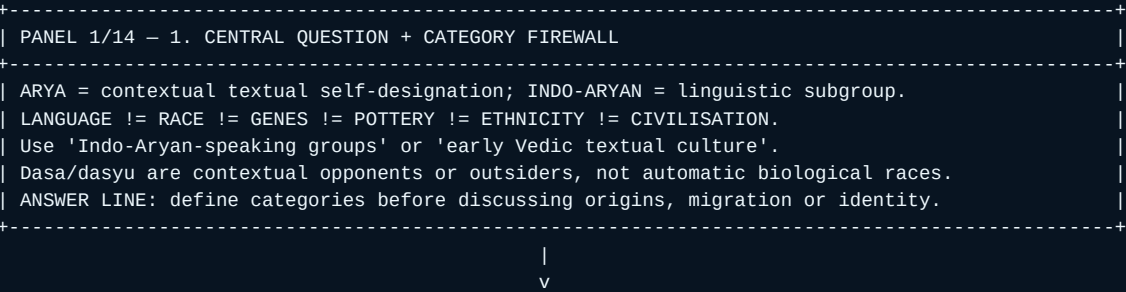


ARYAN PROBLEM — ASCII MASTER | 1/14

THE ARYAN PROBLEM AND IDENTITY OF ARYAN CULTURE – ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM



ARYAN PROBLEM — ASCII MASTER | 2/14

+-----+	
PANEL 2/14 — 2. SCHOLARLY DEBATE: PHILOLOGY TO SOURCE CRITICISM	
+-----+	
Comparative philology found systematic Sanskrit-Avestan-Greek-Latin relationships.	
Colonial theory converted language into race and hierarchy.	
Wheeler linked fort imagery + Mohenjo-daro skeletons to invasion.	
Contextual archaeology rejected one massacre and one destruction horizon.	
Current method retains linguistics but rejects racial and monocausal readings.	
+-----+	
v	

+-----+	
PANEL 3/14 – 3. LINGUISTIC SPINE	
+-----+	
Proto-Indo-European -> Proto-Indo-Iranian -> Indo-Aryan / Iranian / Nuristani.	
Evidence: regular sound correspondences + morphology + inherited vocabulary.	
Vedic soma / Avestan haoma = inheritance plus later divergence.	
Loanwords and areal features must be separated from inherited forms.	
LIMIT: relationship does not by itself fix homeland, route, conquest or genes.	
+-----+	
v	

ARYAN PROBLEM — ASCII MASTER | 4/14

+-----+ PANEL 4/14 — 4. MITANNI + EXTERNAL CHRONOLOGY +-----+	
Bogazkoy treaty, c. 14th century BCE: Mitra, Varuna, Indra, Nasatya forms.	
Kikkuli horse-training tradition: restricted Indo-Aryan technical vocabulary.	
Majority Mitanni language was Hurrian; evidence may reflect an elite superstrate.	
PROVES: Indo-Aryan forms outside South Asia by mid-second millennium BCE.	
DOES NOT PROVE: Rig Veda composed there or a direct Mitanni-to-India migration.	
+-----+	
v	

ARYAN PROBLEM — ASCII MASTER | 5/14

+-----+	
PANEL 5/14 — 5. RIG VEDA: SOURCE + GEOGRAPHY	
+-----+	
Layered oral ritual poetry; family books 2-7 conventionally older.	
North-west focus: Sindhu, Punjab tributaries, Kabul-Swat river world.	
Later Vedic shift: Kuru-Panchala and upper Ganga.	
Sarasvati/Ghaggar-Hakra requires separate hydrology, site and text dating.	
LIMIT: composition zone is not a complete ethnic frontier or migration diary.	
+-----+	
v	

+-----+	
PANEL 6/14 — 6. CULTURAL VOCABULARY + HORSE/CHARIOT TEST	
+-----+	
Cattle wealth + pasture + raids coexist with ploughing, wells and harvesting.	
Balanced phrase: pastoral predominance within an agro-pastoral economy.	
Equid bone -> species/context; horse -> frequency/use; vehicle -> wheel/form/draught.	
Surkotada equid debated; Harappan carts solid-wheel; Sanauli vehicles solid-wheel.	
Sintashta spoked-wheel evidence and Mitanni vocabulary are convergent, not decisive.	
+-----+	
v	

ARYAN PROBLEM — ASCII MASTER | 7/14

+-----+	
PANEL 7/14 — 7. HARAPPAN TO POST-HARAPPAN TRANSFORMATION	
+-----+	
Mature Harappan c.2600-1900 BCE largely precedes conventional Rigvedic horizon.	
Late phase: city contraction + localisation + rural expansion + crop diversity.	
No civilisation-wide military assault; Mohenjo-daro skeletons are not one massacre.	
Cemetery H contains continuity plus mortuary change, not a named migrant people.	
FORMULA: institutional discontinuity with demographic and cultural continuity.	
+-----+	
v	

ARYAN PROBLEM — ASCII MASTER | 8/14

+-----+	
PANEL 8/14 — 8. ARCHAEOLOGICAL CORRELATES WITHOUT ETHNIC LABELS	
+-----+	
Swat/Gandhara Grave = long varied frontier sequence, not one invasion event.	
OCP/copper hoards = uneven associations; many hoards have weak provenance.	
PGW = later Vedic/early Iron Age comparison, not early Rigvedic ethnicity.	
Bhagwanpura overlap shows sequence/contact; it does not identify household language.	
RULE: culture labels map assemblages; objects can move through many mechanisms.	
+-----+	
v	

ARYAN PROBLEM — ASCII MASTER | 9/14

+-----+	
PANEL 9/14 — 9. BMAC-SINTASHTA CORRIDOR	
+-----+	
Sintashta: fortified sites, metallurgy, horses and early spoked-wheel vehicles.	
BMAC: Central Asian oasis settlements, craft and ritual networks.	
Steppe <-> oasis <-> Iran/Hindu Kush/Swat/NW South Asia interaction.	
Mobility can be repeated, household-scale, gender-skewed and network-mediated.	
LIMIT: neither BMAC nor Sintashta independently proves Indo-Aryan language.	
+-----+	
v	

+-----+	
PANEL 10/14 — 10. COMPETING MODELS	
+-----+	
Mass invasion: fails uniform destruction and replacement predictions.	
Strict zero movement: must explain branching, Mitanni and later ancestry evidence.	
Migration only: incomplete if it erases local continuity and acculturation.	
Best broad model: multi-phase movement + interaction + admixture + regional formation.	
UNRESOLVED: exact route, scale, tempo, gender balance and political mechanism.	
+-----+	
v	

```
+-----+
| PANEL 11/14 — 11. ARCHAEOGENETIC METHOD |
+-----+
| Sample + archaeological context -> authentication -> genome -> statistical model. |
| Steppe-related and Iranian-related are affinities, not pure peoples. |
| Check date, region, sex, burial selection, contamination and reference choice. |
| Admixture dates are ranges; one cemetery is not a population census. |
| GENES cannot directly identify language, religion, caste or self-designation. |
+-----+
|
v
```

+-----+	
PANEL 12/14 — 12. RAKHIGARHI + NARASIMHAN 2019	
+-----+	
Shinde et al., Cell 2019: one Rakhigarhi individual; no detectable Steppe ancestry.	
Its Iranian-related ancestry was not simple recent western-farmer ancestry.	
Narasimhan et al., Science 2019: 523 ancient individuals across a wider region.	
Supports later Steppe-related movement + extensive IVC-related continuity/mixture.	
LIMIT: consistency with language spread is not direct genetic proof of language.	
+-----+	
v	

ARYAN PROBLEM — ASCII MASTER | 13/14

+-----+	
PANEL 13/14 — 13. IDENTITY FORMATION + POLITICAL MISUSE	
+-----+	
Movement + bilingualism + marriage + alliance/conflict + borrowing -> ethnogenesis.	
Non-Indo-European words/names and areal features support contact in South Asia.	
Migration does not imply permanent foreignness; continuity does not imply purity.	
Ancient genes, pots and terms cannot allocate modern ownership or legitimacy.	
Neutrality = transparent categories and evidence weights, not false equivalence.	
+-----+	
v	

ARYAN PROBLEM — ASCII MASTER | 14/14

+-----+	
PANEL 14/14 — 14. PYQ ROUTE + ANSWER SPINE + VERDICT	
+-----+	
Direct routed Aryan-origin/migration PYQs, 2018-2026: ZERO.	
Adjacent routes: 2023/2024 Vedic Mains; 2026 vocabulary/geography Prelims.	
WRITE: define -> chronology -> linguistics -> text -> archaeology -> genetics.	
Then compare models -> secure/probable/unresolved -> qualified conclusion.	
VERDICT: movement and interaction are likely; race and one-culture equations fail.	
+-----+	